BLOODSTOCK
EPISODE ONE - BLOOD BOUND

Written by

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TEASER

Sound of BREATH, heavy, uneven - PANICKED. The CRUNCHING of leaves under someone's feet as they run. FADE UP ON:

EXT. WOODS - LOUISIANA - NIGHT

Slowly, our eyes adjust and we're moving through a DENSE WOODS, deep in LOUISIANA. Moonlight filters through the trees, giving us brief glimpses of:

A YOUNG WOMAN with long, blonde hair, running for her life. Her bare feet fly across leaves and mud. Branches lash at her bloody arms and legs. We hear her WHIMPER and PANT.

Faintly, we hear the sound of a MAN'S LAUGHTER coming from behind her.

YOUNG WOMAN
(out of breath, shouting)
Why are you doing this!?

EXT. WOODS - LOUISIANA - CONTINUOUS

We follow our runner from behind as she trips down a DITCH and falls into the muddy water of a SWAMP. She looks up.

Inside the water are several ABANDONED CARS, becoming one with the land.

She gets to her feet then SPRINTS up the ditch, when suddenly she CRIES OUT in pain, falling to her knees.

CLOSE ON a HUMAN BONE, pierced through her FOOT and poking out the other side.

She grits her teeth and RIPS IT OUT with a CRY then tosses it to the ground. It rattles on the ground, forcing her to take notice of:

HUMAN BONES, scattered over the ground around her. She lets out a single, strained, SCREAM.

Suddenly, a shadowed FIGURE comes up behind her, holding a BASEBALL BAT. They swing and connect it with her head.

We hear her body drop to the ground as we CUT TO BLACK.

END TEASER

OVER BLACK

GRETA (V.O.)
You can tell a lot about someone by how they act before they die. Fight. Flight. Freeze. Fawn. Or some combination of the four.

EXT. COUNTRY ROAD - LOUISIANA - DAY

Giant oak and cypress trees spread their branches over a narrow, winding road like worried parents shielding it from the hot summer sun. An old, beat up ‘69 PLYMOUTH FURY speeds down the road.

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INT. PLYMOUTH - CONTINUOUS

Driving the beater is a scrawny young woman with ginger hair and heavy eye bags. This is GRETA (22-26).

GRETA (V.O.)
But really it doesn’t matter if you’re a fighter, or a coward, or a killer. You end up dead either way.

Greta grips the wheel tightly while whipping around curves. She looks between the road and her PHONE, which sits on a dashboard mount showing GPS directions.

The screen occasionally lights up with text notifications from “MOM”.

CLOSE UP OF PHONE SCREEN:

MOM - *When are you going to call me back?*

MOM - *It’s not too much to ask, is it?*

MOM - *Remember who’s paying your tuition. At least let me know you’re alive.*

Greta ignores the messages, swiping each of them away when they show up.

OUT THE WINDSHIELD the road straightens out and looks like it goes on forever.

Greta sighs and picks up her phone. She clicks her mother's contact to call her back.

Ironically, it goes to voicemail. Greta rolls her eyes.

After the beep:

GRETA
Hey, Mom, it's me. Just calling you back. I left a couple hours ago. My GPS has me around 6 out, still. I'm sorry for not calling you back sooner, I've just been a little overwhelmed... I'll see you soon, I love--

BEEP BEEP BEEP

Her phone cuts her off. She has LOST SIGNAL.

GRETA (CONT'D)
(under her breath)
Fuck.

She sets her phone back on the dashboard mount. As she is distracted doing this, she is startled by a loud CAR HORN.

She looks up quickly; realizes she's SWERVED INTO THE OTHER LANE, and about to go head-on with another car. She quickly jerks the car back into her own lane, but over-swerves OFF THE ROAD in doing so.

We hear a loud METALLIC THUD under the car.

GRETA (CONT'D)
God damn it!

She gets the car straightened out, but as soon as she's back on the road, the engine begins to SPUTTER. On the dashboard are several WARNING LIGHTS.

GRETA (CONT'D)
Come on, not now, please!

The engine cuts out. She coasts it to the side of the road. Moment of quiet frustration before Greta exhales sharply and rests her head on the steering wheel.

GRETA (V.O.)
The day I met the Jackson Family, I was just trying to get home.

<u>EXT. COUNTRY ROAD - LOUISIANA - DAY</u>

Greta exits the car. She takes in her surroundings. It's quiet, and the road stretches far in both directions.

She takes out her phone and looks at it: still NO SIGNAL.

GRETA
Great.

The car has FLUID DRIPPING from underneath the front end.

She folds the front seat down and grabs her PURSE and a DIGITAL CAMERA from the backseat. She shuts the door, locking it manually.

She stares at the car for a beat, then begins walking down the road in the direction she was driving in.

We stay at a low angle beside her car as she walks off, watching and hearing the fluid DRIP onto the ground below. Once she gets far enough away to come out of focus, we

CUT TO:

EXT. RESTAURANT - DAY

Greta comes upon a small, WEATHERED RESTAURANT on the side of the road. It's got a COUNTRY WESTERN AESTHETIC. Probably a tourist trap at one time, styled to draw in folks passing by on the old highway.

A rustic SIGN hangs near the road: “OUTLAWS Old West Eats”

Greta’s feet drag a bit as she walks. She’s tired and hot.

She checks her phone: has 2 BARS.

GRETA
Thank god...

She approaches the restaurant. There are a few trucks parked out front. It's not dead, at least. She pushes open the front doors, styled to look like OLD SALOON DOORS.

INT. RESTAURANT - DAY

The interior matches the outside. Totally fake and designed to look like an old western, but it hasn't been changed in years. A few patrons sit around the place, their heads down, nursing drinks or eating in silence.

A WAITRESS calls to Greta from the bar.

WAITRESS
Sit wherever you like, dear! I'll get you taken care of.

Greta gives a tired smile and takes a seat at the bar. She takes out her phone.

CLOSE UP OF PHONE SCREEN: *Calling Roadside Assistance.*

GRETA
(to herself)
Finally.

She sits back anxiously as the phone rings.

Eventually, a muffled voice comes through on the other side. It is unintelligible to us what they say.

GRETA (CONT'D)
Hi, yes I need a tow to the nearest auto repair shop, please. For a '69 Plymouth Fury.

A beat. More unintelligible speaking through the phone.

GRETA (CONT'D)
Yeah I swerved a deer and ended up going off the road... I don't know what I ran over-- but it messed up something underneath.

A beat.

GRETA (CONT'D)
Yes. Exactly. Yeah it's leaking fluid of some kind. It's uh-- Russel Road, right off of 10.

A beat.

GRETA (CONT'D)
(surprised, exhausted)
How long? No-- I don't have service out there, I'm at a restaurant about a mile up the road.

A beat.

GRETA (CONT'D)
Okay great. Please let me know. Thanks so much...

She hangs up.

GRETA (CONT'D)
(to herself, under her breath)
Fuck!

The waitress approaches her.

WAITRESS
Can I help you, sugar?

GRETA
Just a coffee and a water, thanks...

WAITRESS
Of course.

The waitress walks away. Greta shifts uncomfortably on the bar stool. Her phone BUZZES.

CLOSE UP OF PHONE SCREEN:

ROADSIDE - *You are on our waiting list! Estimated wait is: 6 HR*

Before Greta can delve into a deeper frustration, she is startled by a MAN'S VOICE from down the bar.

LUKE
(off screen)
Car trouble?

Greta's jumpiness causes her to DROP her phone. It clatters to the ground.

GRETA
(startled)
Jesus Christ!

Greta turns to see a handsome country boy with blond hair picking her phone off the ground and handing it back to her. This is LUKE (26).

Greta checks if the phone is broken; it is NOT.

LUKE
You really should get a case for that...

GRETA
(irritated, shaking off her spook)
Noted. Do you always eavesdrop on people’s private conversations?

LUKE
Only when they're pretty girls.

Greta raises an eyebrow. Hint of a smile. She's not quite sure how to take Luke's comment.

He sits a stool over from her.

LUKE (CONT'D)
I'm Luke.

GRETA
Greta.
(a laugh)
Pretty girls? You must be pretty bored out here.

Luke leans back, clearly unaffected by her sarcasm.

LUKE
You could say that. Y'aint from around here though, so what brings you to the middle of nowhere?

GRETA
Just passing through. My car had other plans...

Greta's MIDWESTERN ACCENT stands out strikingly amongst the Cajun ones around her.

The waitress comes back and sets down her coffee and water. Greta takes a drink of the water.

LUKE
How far out?

GRETA
Like a mile, I think... Took me about 20 minutes to walk here, so maybe a little more.

LUKE
Well, you're in luck. My family's place isn't far. We've got a shop, maybe I can take a look at it. Get you back on the road.

Greta stares at him for a moment, still unsure if he's serious or just being overly friendly. She's exhausted, both physically and emotionally.

GRETA
Really? That's... nice of you, but I already called roadside. Six hours, apparently.

Luke chuckles, shaking his head.

LUKE
Six hours? Out here? You'll be lucky if they show up at all.

Greta bites her lip, irritated.

LUKE (CONT'D)
I'm serious, though. My daddy's got a trailer, and I know my way around cars. At least I can take a look while you're waiting, and if I can't do nothin' we will find you a repair shop first thing.

GRETA
I don't want to put you out...

LUKE
Nah, no trouble at all. It's just me, my brother, and my folks out there. Mom's a sucker for helping out anyone in a tough spot. Runs an animal sanctuary. You'll like it. Quiet, good air... Might be a good break from your road trip.

Greta pauses for a moment. The waitress WALKS BY them behind the bar.

GRETA
(to the WAITRESS)
Excuse me ma'am.

The waitress turns to Greta.

WAITRESS
Yes, honey?

GRETA
You know this guy?

The waitress looks at Luke. They both smile. The waitress gives a bit of a laugh.

WAITRESS
Course I do, sweetheart! The Jacksons have been around here longer than I have, for damn sure. Good people; always first to lend a hand when folks are in a pinch.

LUKE
Told ya.

GRETA
So I can trust him to give me a ride, then?

WAITRESS
Absolutely, honey. I think his mama might skin him alive if he ever laid a hand on a woman.

Greta shakes her head. She laughs off her nerves.

GRETA
Alright... thanks ma'am.

WAITRESS
Don't mention it, sugar.

The waitress pats the counter and WALKS OFF.

Greta looks out the window toward the road. She takes a long DRINK of her coffee.

GRETA
(under her breath)
Fuck...
(to LUKE)
I guess it beats waiting out here for 6 hours.

LUKE
Considering this place closes in 2, I'd say so.

Luke winks.

Greta's eyes widen. Luke stands and puts on a straw hat he had sat on the bar.

LUKE (CONT'D)
I'll pull the truck 'round. We'll go get the trailer from my folks and have your car back to mine in less than an hour.

Greta nods. Luke grins, tipping his hat at her before he leaves the restaurant.

GRETA (V.O.)
I'll admit, I fell for his southern charm.
(MORE)

GRETA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
I guess that can-do attitude and kind demeanor might be why I trusted him. Or maybe I just didn't wanna keep pretending I had other options.

CUT TO:

EXT. RESTAURANT - EVENING

Greta stands outside the restaurant, leaning against the railing as Luke pulls up in a lifted, well-maintained 80s FORD TRUCK. His window is down and he smiles at her. She walks up to the passenger door, opening it.

She looks down the long stretch of road before hopping in the truck.

The door slams shut and we

CUT TO:

INT. LUKE'S TRUCK - LATER

The ride is quiet. Luke drives with one hand on the wheel, the other resting on the door.

Greta looks out the window, her fingers idly mess with her camera strap.

LUKE
So where you headed, anyway?

GRETA
Home. Missouri. It's the last summer before my senior year, and it's been... a while since I saw my mother.

Luke nods but doesn't pry.

A beat.

LUKE
You a photographer or somethin'?

GRETA
Huh? Oh. Yeah-- Well, trying to be. Hoping I can build my portfolio over the summer.

Luke smiles.

LUKE
You can get some good shots at our place. Horses, barns, trees... People love that stuff, don't they?

Greta chuckles.

GRETA
Sure.

EXT/INT. LUKE'S TRUCK - DIRT ROAD - EVENING

The truck turns off the main road onto a NARROW DIRT ROAD. The trees grow denser, creating a canopy that blocks out most of the sunlight.

EXT. JACKSON FARM - EVENING

The trees suddenly CLEAR OUT, and the two have reached **THE JACKSON FARM.**

The golden yellow sunset shines on grand wooden gates. PASTURE FENCES line the long, STONE DRIVEWAY, and HORSES can be seen grazing inside them.

The gates open, and we follow behind Luke's truck as they drive down the driveway, which leads TO:

A large, Plantation style farmhouse. A sign on the front porch reads: **“JACKSON FAMILY RANCH. EST 1837.”**

Massive, double doors are the centerpiece of the porch. The architecture is Antebellum, but the siding and roof have been replaced, and there have been additions to the house, modernizing it.

GRETA (V.O.)
The place looked like it had been plucked out of a distant dream. Like the ones of those golden, endless summer afternoons you thought would last forever.

The Jackson family has had money for a very long time. For an old ranch in Bayou Country, it oozes with class.

Greta is slightly in awe. Shocked at the beauty of the farm. It is clear by her demeanor and possessions that she does NOT come from money. She’s painfully out of place here.

Luke pulls the truck to a stop at the front of the house. He hops out and waves Greta out.

LUKE
C'mon! I'll introduce you to my folks!

Greta steps out of the truck and slowly takes in her surroundings. A few HORSES graze in a PASTURE to the right.

Greta notes that beside the house is a large GARAGE, its open door tells us that Luke was not lying about having the equipment to work on her car.

Luke walks towards the house. Greta lags behind, still caught up in the scenery.

As they approach, the front door opens and a tall, beautiful, aging woman steps out onto the porch. This is ALYSSA (45-55). Her blonde hair is meticulously pinned up. Her thin, modelesque stature is imposing.

Greta stops. The rest of the farm falls away, obsolete, as her entire world narrows to the woman on the porch.

She, just as well, catches Alyssa's eye instantly.

GRETA (V.O.)
Alyssa Jackson had a presence that dropped you dead. Just a look from her would rip all the air from your lungs... and still--
You'd do anything not to look away.

Alyssa looks over Greta quickly, then flashes a smile.

ALYSSA
Luke! You didn't tell me we were having company this evening.

Luke smiles at his mother. The resemblance between them is undeniable.

LUKE
Car trouble. Found her stranded at *Outlaws*. Thought we could help her out.

Alyssa steps down off of the porch, and her gaze locks solely onto Greta. Her expression is more measured than it is kind. She extends a hand.

ALYSSA
Alyssa Jackson. What's your name, miss car trouble?

FOR MORE PAGES OF THIS SCRIPT, CONTACT GRACE DARLING.